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## State of Ohio Administrative Policy

### Fleet Telematics

**No: VF-04**

Office of Fleet Management

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**Effective:**

October 10, 2024

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**Issued By:**

Kathleen C. Madden, Director

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#### I. Purpose

To establish statewide requirements for the use of **Telematics** equipment and data associated with state fleet vehicles within the Department of Administrative Services' (DAS) Managed Fleet Program. The first occurrence of a defined term in the policy body is in bold, italic type, and is hyperlinked to the definition in Section IV.

#### II. Scope

The Managed Fleet Program is provided by DAS's Office of Fleet Management (OFM) to participating state agencies. This policy applies to all employees operating a state fleet vehicle that is within the Managed Fleet Program.

#### III. Policy

The Telematics equipment is used to monitor state fleet vehicle location and performance, which is intended to improve employee safety, operational efficiency, energy efficiency, and reduce costs. Use of Telematics data is intended to increase productivity and efficiency by tracking dispatching, routing, vehicle utilization, fuel economy, and preventative maintenance.

- A. **Information Collection.** Data obtained from Telematics is a valuable tool for operations and customer service that helps the State improve employee safety and extend the useful life and quality of the State's fleet. Telematics collects information about state fleet vehicles such as location, speed, route, stopping, maneuvering severity, idle and parking time, and impact/crash notification. The State of Ohio uses this information to benefit the State and the customers it serves.

- B. **Designated Public Service Workers.** Upon written request by an agency to OFM, state fleet vehicles within the Managed Fleet Program that are utilized by Designated Public Service Workers may be equipped with a Telematics system that collects only engine diagnostic and basic utilization data. OFM is responsible for determining whether an employee is a Designated Public Service Worker for purposes of this section.
- C. **No Expectation of Privacy.** Employees have no expectation of privacy while using a state fleet vehicle. The state reserves the right to use Telematics data to monitor state fleet vehicles.
- D. **Agency Responsibilities**
1. Agencies are responsible for informing employees that all vehicle operation is monitored by Telematics and providing a copy of this policy, as well as any agency- specific policy, to an employee who drives a state fleet vehicle. State agencies are permitted to issue additional policies and guidance on Telematics that expand on this policy where necessary to meet their unique needs.
  2. Agencies are responsible for enforcing compliance with this policy, the statewide Motor Vehicle Fleet Policy (VF-01), and any agency-specific guidance authorizing the use of state vehicles.
  3. Each state agency's Telematics data and driver performance review process shall include the agency Fleet Coordinators, agency leadership and designated managers, and agency human resources representatives.
  4. Each agency will review its fleet Telematics data to ensure drivers eliminate unsafe and unauthorized driving behaviors. Regular monitoring of Telematics data for individual agency fleet programs is the responsibility of agency Fleet Coordinators or the agency person who manages day-to-day fleet operations as assigned.
  5. Agencies are responsible for addressing motor vehicle violations through appropriate agency policies and procedures.
- E. **Use of DAS Motor Pool:** Employees utilizing the DAS motor pool will acknowledge this policy during the vehicle reservation process.
- F. **Prohibited Activities:** The improper, careless, negligent, destructive, or unsafe use or operation of state fleet vehicles and equipment, as well as the failure to report such use or operation and the failure to report damage or repair needs, may result in loss of the ability to utilize a state fleet vehicle under the statewide Motor Vehicle Fleet Policy (VF-01), loss of insurance coverage under the statewide Self-Insured Vehicle Liability Program (VF-02), and corrective or disciplinary action, including termination. The following activities are also prohibited:
1. Tampering with or altering the physical Telematics equipment in a state or agency fleet vehicle.
  2. Intentionally blocking or interfering with the electrical systems, wireless signal, or satellite receiver/antenna.
  3. Attempting to repair or adjust the Telematics system in an agency state or agency fleet vehicle.

Employees who believe that the Telematics system in any fleet vehicle is not working properly should report the malfunction immediately to their agency's Fleet Coordinator.

**G. Public Records Requests**

1. Public records requests received by DAS for records containing individualized Telematics data shall be sent to the applicable agency Fleet Coordinator for processing and response pursuant to that agency's public records policy.
2. Public records requests received by an agency participating in the DAS Managed Fleet Program for records containing engine diagnostic and basic utilization Telematics data shall be sent to the DAS Fleet Manager for processing and response pursuant to DAS' public records policy.

**IV. Definitions**

- A. Telematics. Technology that provides global positioning data, vehicle diagnostic data, and vehicle usage data to be used to improve fleet management costs, sustainability, efficiency, and safety.
- B. Designated Public Service Worker. Those positions listed in Section 149.43(A)(7) of the Ohio Revised Code, and those positions that an agency demonstrates to OFM would be subject to a safety risk to themselves or others if their assigned state fleet vehicle were equipped with GPS monitoring.

**V. Authority**

ORC 124.832

**VI. Resources**

| Document Name                           | Location     |
|-----------------------------------------|--------------|
| Model Agency Policy on Fleet Telematics | Attachment 1 |

**VII. Inquiries**

Inquiries about this policy should be directed to:

Office of Fleet Management

General Services Division

Ohio Department of Administrative Services

4200 Surface Road

Columbus, OH 43228

614-466-6607

[dasfleet@das.ohio.gov](mailto:dasfleet@das.ohio.gov)

State of Ohio Administrative Policies may be found online at

<https://das.ohio.gov/home/policy-finder/filter-policy-finder>

**VIII. Revision History**

| <b>Date</b> | <b>Description of Change</b>                                                                                                               |
|-------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 4/11/2022   | Original policy.                                                                                                                           |
| 1/20/2023   | Revised the policy to clarify agency requirements and prohibited activities.                                                               |
| 9/5/2023    | Revised the policy to add information about Designated Public Service Workers and public records requests. Updated to new policy template. |
| 10/10/2024  | Revised the policy to modify the definition of Designated Public Safety Worker.                                                            |

**ATTACHMENT 1: Model Agency Policy on Use of DAS and Agency Vehicles****I. Purpose**

This policy establishes requirements for the use and safe operation of state vehicles and provides notice to [Agency] employees about the utilization of ***Telematics*** equipment in fleet and motor pool vehicles (Vehicles). The first occurrence of the word in the policy is in bold, italic type.

**II. Scope**

This policy applies to all [Agency] employees who use a Vehicle. If any provision of this policy conflicts with the terms of an applicable collective bargaining agreement, the terms of the collection bargaining agreement prevail.

**III. Policy**

- A. **Authorized and Unauthorized Use:** When using a Vehicle, employees are required to abide by [State of Ohio Administrative Policy VF-01, Employee's Use of Employer Provided Vehicles](#) and State of Ohio Administrative Policy ORM-02, State Self-Insured Motor Vehicle Liability and Self-Insured Vehicle Damage Program.
- B. **No Expectation of Privacy:** Employees have no expectation of privacy while using a Vehicle. [Agency] reserves the right to use Telematics data to monitor Vehicles.
- C. **Prohibited Activities:** The improper, careless, negligent, destructive, or unsafe operation of Vehicles and equipment, as well as the failure to report such use or operation and the failure to report damage or repair needs, may result in loss of the ability to utilize a Vehicle under State of Ohio Administrative Policy VF-01, loss of insurance coverage under State of Ohio Administrative Policy ORM-02, and corrective or disciplinary action, including termination.

Additionally, the following activities are prohibited:

- 1. Tampering with or altering the physical Telematics equipment in a Vehicle.
- 2. Intentionally blocking or interfering with the electrical systems, wireless signal, or satellite receiver/antenna in a Vehicle.
- 3. Attempting to repair or adjust the Telematics system in Vehicle.

Employees who believe that the Telematics system in a Vehicle is not working properly should report the malfunction immediately to the [Agency] Fleet Coordinator.

**IV. Definitions**

Telematics. Technology that provides global positioning data, vehicle diagnostic data, and vehicle usage data, and which is used to monitor DAS Vehicle location and performance and is intended to improve employee safety, operational efficiency, energy efficiency, and reduce costs.

## V. Authority

ORC 125.832  
State of Ohio Administrative Policy VF-04, Fleet Telematics

## VI. Resources

| Document Name                              | Location                                                     |
|--------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|
| State of Ohio Administrative Policy VF-01  | <a href="#">Employee's Use of Employer Provided Vehicles</a> |
| State of Ohio Administrative Policy ORM-02 | <a href="#">Self-Insured Motor Vehicle Liability</a>         |

## VII. Inquiries

Direct inquiries about this policy to:

Office of Fleet Management  
General Services Division  
Ohio Department of Administrative Services  
4200 Surface Road, Columbus, Ohio 43228  
614-466-6607 | [dasfleet@das.ohio.gov](mailto:dasfleet@das.ohio.gov)

State of Ohio Administrative Policies may be found online at  
<https://das.ohio.gov/home/policy-finder/filter-policy-finder>

## VIII. Revision History

| Date       | Description of Change                                                                                          |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 04/11/2022 | Original policy                                                                                                |
| 1/20/2023  | Revised the policy to clarify agency requirements and prohibited activities.                                   |
| 09/05/2023 | Revised the policy to add information about Designated Public Service Workers. Updated to new policy template. |